

Lab 4: Executive Briefing Challenge

Time: 30 minutes

What you need: Claude.ai Pro or Team account

Files provided: Use files from Labs 2-3, plus `executive-briefing-inputs.txt`

The Challenge

Your CEO just pinged you: "Board meeting moved to Wednesday. I need a 2-page briefing on our competitive position and Q4 performance. Include a recommendation on where to invest in Q1. On my desk by end of day."

You have everything you need from today's labs. Now put it all together.

Step 1: Set Up Your Project (5 min)

1. Create a new Project: "**Board Briefing - Q1 2026**"
2. Add Custom Instructions:

Audience: CEO and Board of Directors
Tone: Executive – confident, concise, data-driven
Format: Professional briefing with headers, no fluff
Numbers: Always include specific figures, percentages, and comparisons
Recommendations: Always support with data from the uploaded files
Length: Concise – executives skim, not read

1. Upload these files to the Project:
 2. `q4-sales-data.csv` (from Lab 3)
 3. `competitor-intel.txt` (from Lab 3)
 4. `executive-briefing-inputs.txt` (new — strategic context)
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Step 2: Build the Briefing (15 min)

Work through these prompts in sequence. Each builds on the last.

Prompt 1 — Extract key metrics:

"Review all uploaded files. Extract the 5 most important metrics a CEO would want to see for a board meeting. Include the actual numbers."

Prompt 2 — Competitive position:

"Write a 'Competitive Landscape' section for the board briefing. Summarize our position vs. the 3 competitors. Highlight the biggest threat and our biggest advantage. Keep it to one paragraph."

Prompt 3 — Build the full briefing:

"Create a 2-page Executive Briefing artifact for the CEO. Include: 1. Q4 Performance Snapshot (key metrics in a table) 2. Competitive Landscape (from our analysis) 3. Risk Factors (what could hurt us in Q1) 4. Q1 Investment Recommendation (where to spend, with justification)

Format it as a professional document — headers, tables where appropriate, clear section breaks. This goes to the board."

Prompt 4 — Iterate:

"The CEO prefers bullet points over paragraphs in risk sections. Also add a one-line summary at the very top — a 'bottom line up front' the board can read in 10 seconds."

Step 3: Polish and Present (10 min)

Add a visual:

"Create a simple table or chart showing Q4 revenue by region with quota comparison. Include it in the briefing."

Quality check:

"Review this briefing as if you were the CEO's chief of staff. Flag anything that's vague, unsupported by data, or missing. Then fix it."

Final version:

"Give me the final version as a clean artifact I can copy into a Word document."

Share with the Class

If time permits, your instructor will ask: 1. What's your "bottom line up front"? 2. What's your Q1 investment recommendation? 3. What surprised you about the data?

Reflection: What You Did Today

Time	Without Claude	With Claude
Q4 Analysis	2-3 hours	10 minutes
Battle Card	1-2 hours	10 minutes
Board Briefing	Half a day	30 minutes
Total	4-7 hours	~1 hour

This isn't about replacing your judgment. You still decided what matters, what to recommend, and what to cut. Claude handled the heavy lifting so you could focus on the thinking.

What You're Taking Home

From today's 4 labs, you built: 1. ☐ Prompting skills you'll use every day (Lab 1) 2. ☐ A personalized AI workspace — settings, preferences, Project (Lab 2) 3. ☐ Data analysis and competitive intelligence workflow (Lab 3) 4. ☐ A board-ready executive briefing (Lab 4) 5. ☐ Reusable prompts and Project templates

Monday morning: Open Claude, open your Project, start working.

"The goal isn't to use AI. The goal is to get better work done faster. AI is how."